

Launched

Asus launches M4 series of motherboards that support the new AM3 socket from AMD

TRIED & TESTED

HostedFTP.com

Fast, simple to use, effective online space provider

HostedFTP.com is an online file storage provider in a space now filled with many sites. HostedFTP.com brings a little more to this space. What makes the service great is the interface. All the features are organised into separate tabs. Registration is simple and it doesn't take time to get used to the features as well. A welcome page greets you when you log into the service. It works well with all the usual browsers without any glitches.

When you create an account, you not only get to upload files but you have the option to add other users or even allow public access to files. Groups can be created out of your user lists as well. Files can be uploaded using the web interface and Java applet that is embedded on the site. FTP access is available for you as well.

Invites can be sent to users to download separate files or packages which are simply group of files. You are notified by mail when download made using the invites. Quotas can be sent as well. With user lists created, a particular file or package can be set easily to a particular group.

File handling is simple with the web interface. Files can be moved, renamed and downloaded. A public folder is available and you have the option to have public files deleted after a set period of time. You can also have users enter information before downloading a file from the public space.

There is some amount of customization as well. You can put your web site name, a banner and a splash image for

your account and your users will be shown the same. Most of the actions on HostedFTP.com are wizard-based, so it's simple to operate and use. Help is provided for every feature of the site.

There are schemes you can choose from and they have storage constraints — 2 GB, 4 GB and 16 GB depending on your needs. There are some download limitations and very minimal charges if you cross it. The service is excellent for personal use and even better for small groups of companies in multiple locations and you need a easy, secure and quick way to exchange large files.

Ratings (on 10)

Features: 8
Performance: 8
Ease of Use: 8
Value for money: 7
Overall: 8

Contact: HostedFTP.com
Web site: www.hostedftp.com
Price: Personal Edition 2 GB (\$10),
Group Edition 8 GB (\$ 40),
Enterprise Edition 16 GB (\$80)



Seagate Barracuda 7200.11 1.5 TB

The Barracuda just got bigger

Seagate has always been a brand talked about when deciding which hard drive to purchase. Seagate took its own time to release its 1 TB drive, but seems to have pulled up with a 1.5-TB drive under the 7200.11 series.

The drive is silent. It doesn't heat up as expected and stays at a stable warm temperature too. We tested the performance of this hard drive through a series of test including HD Tach, SiSoft Sandra and even ran file transfer tests. In HD Tach, we got really great read and write speeds better than what you would expect from a 1.5-TB drive. SiSoft Sandra gave us slightly lower scores in comparison to HD Tach. The random access time matched in both the tests. We also performed some 4 GB sequential and assorted file transfer tests to

find out good it performed. In the sequential transfer tests, we got a read time of 68.4 seconds, a write time of 72 seconds and an internal copy time of the sequential file took 114 seconds. With the assorted file tests, we got a read time of 83.7 seconds, a write time of 80.5 seconds and an internal copy time of 102.7 seconds.

As you can see, it does have some great read and write times shown in the file transfer test, and therefore, is an

ideal drive to purchase if you're looking to expand. Anyway, this is perfect as it will be pretty future-proof when building a new rig and definitely recommend it.

Specifications:

Dimensions: 26.1 x 101.6 x 146.99 mm (H x W x L), Interface: SATA 3.0 Gbps, Cache: 32 MB, Capacity: 1.5 TB

Ratings (on10)

Features: 7
Performance: 8
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 7
Overall: 7.5

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Price: Rs. 8,250 + VAT

